

JasinaHub

Privacy Policy

This policy explains how **JasinaHub** (the “Service”) collects, uses, shares, and protects information when you use its hosted website and Progressive Web Application, contribute speech or text, transcribe recordings, or contact the project. JasinaHub is an open-source web platform developed by the **Centre for Data Science and Artificial Intelligence (DSAIL)** at **Dedan Kimathi University of Technology (DeKUT)**. In this policy, “we”, “our”, and “us” refer to DeKUT acting through DSAIL, the data controller for the Service.

Participation is voluntary. Recordings and related data are uploaded to managed cloud services, not kept exclusively on your device. We do not sell personal data. Dataset exports omit contributor names, but voices may remain identifiable. Open-source access to the software does not make participant data publicly available.

Read this policy together with the informed-consent information presented before participation. Additional or more restrictive project-specific consent conditions also apply.

1. Information We Collect

We collect information directly from you, through administrators, and automatically through operation of the Service:

- **Account and contact details:** email address, password, first and last name, telephone number, age, gender, and dialect; administrator-verification status, account role, and transcription approval. Required fields are identified in the registration form; without them, you cannot create or verify an account. Other fields are optional.
- **Contributions and consent:** voice recordings in WebM/Opus format, text responses, prompts, recording duration, transcripts, corrections, timestamps, and review status; whether and when you consented to participation and accepted transcription guidelines.
- **Participant and sensitive information:** language, dialect, demographics, and other project-specific attributes you provide. We do not collect clinical records as part of this workflow.
- **Operational and usage information:** page visits, submissions, task reservations and expiry times, progress, presence, network state, browser/device information, error and security logs, review decisions, and administrative actions. These records may be linked to your account; they are not necessarily non-personal telemetry.
- **Feedback:** responses about your experience with the Service. Feedback records are stored anonymously to limit identification of responses with users. Avoid including personally-identifying details in feedback.

Browser storage. Supabase GoTrue stores session information for authentication. JasinaHub uses `localStorage` for recoverable audio copies, browser storage for unfinished transcripts, and service-worker caching for interface resources. These support interrupted-upload recovery and the installable application. Activity and presence records are stored in the managed database. Browser recovery does not mean that submitted data remain local; see Section 4.

Voice identifiability. Personal data include information relating to an identifiable person. Removing a name from audio does not make it anonymous: a familiar person or technical system

may recognise the speaker. Voice processed for unique identification may constitute biometric data. A response may also reveal information about someone else.

2. How and Why We Use Information

We use information to:

- create, authenticate, verify, and administer accounts, roles, and requested support;
- collect spontaneous and read speech or text, prepare and review transcripts, curate datasets, and measure contribution progress;
- develop, train, adapt, test, and evaluate speech and language technologies, including automatic speech recognition systems such as Jasina ASR;
- coordinate transcription tasks, recover interrupted work, prevent misuse, investigate errors or incidents, and maintain audit records;
- improve performance, data quality, and usability, and report research findings and aggregate participation statistics; and
- respond to data-rights requests and meet applicable legal and research-governance requirements.

Legal grounds and consent. Under Kenya's Data Protection Act, 2019 and applicable regulations, the purposes and grounds described by this policy are:

- **Requested account services and support:** steps necessary to provide the Service requested by the user.
- **Contribution collection, research, and compatible model development:** explicit informed consent and the applicable condition for sensitive-data processing.
- **Security, task coordination, quality assurance, and improvement:** legitimate operational, research, and security interests, assessed against your rights and freedoms; this does not override limits in your research consent.
- **Required records and regulatory responses:** applicable legal obligations. Institutional and ethics requirements also govern how the project operates.
- **Controlled research sharing:** participant consent and documented project-governance and data-access conditions.

Future research is limited to compatible speech, language, data-quality, accessibility, and related language-technology research explained when consent was obtained. Materially incompatible use, public release of identifiable recordings, or materially broader sharing requires a new lawful basis and fresh consent where required. Before new high-risk processing or material changes, DSAIL will complete or review a Data Protection Impact Assessment and record the applicable sensitive-data condition.

Ethics approval. This study was reviewed and approved by the Dedan Kimathi University of Technology Scientific Ethics Review Committee, approval number DeKUT/ISREC/03422/109.

Automated functions and human review. The Service calculates progress, retires prompts at configured response thresholds, selects eligible transcription candidates, manages expiring task locks and skipped candidates, records activity and presence, and detects recoverable work. Administrators manually verify volunteers, approve transcribers, review recordings and transcripts, and authorise exports. The described Service does not make legal or similarly significant participant decisions solely by automated means. You may request reconsideration using Section 6.

3. Sharing and International Transfers

We do not sell personal data or use participant contact details for unrelated commercial advertising. We limit access to what is needed for an authorised purpose. Recipients may include:

- authorised DSAIL/DeKUT staff, administrators, and approved transcribers with access to temporarily reserved recordings;
- **Supabase**, providing authentication, managed PostgreSQL, serverless functions, and audio storage, and **Vercel**, providing web hosting and delivery;
- authorised research collaborators and controlled-dataset recipients whose proposed use is consistent with participant consent and project governance;
- institutional ethics, audit, legal, security, and research-oversight personnel; and
- courts, regulators, law-enforcement bodies, or other authorities where disclosure is lawfully required or necessary to protect a person, the Service, or legal rights.

Dataset exports replace names with unique contributor codes. This is *pseudonymisation*: contributions from the same person remain linked, and audio, transcripts, prompts, demographics, dialect, and provenance may remain identifiable. Access is controlled rather than treated as anonymous public release.

Providers and research recipients must limit use to the authorised purpose and comply with contractual and legal safeguards. Funding alone does not grant access to participant-level data. The software's open-source licence does not authorise access to or unrestricted reuse of contributed data.

4. Storage, Retention, and Security

Local and cloud storage. Submitted recordings and associated records are stored in managed cloud infrastructure. Unsent audio and unfinished transcripts may also remain in your browser for recovery. A local copy may remain until successful handling, removal by you or the Service, or clearing or eviction by the browser. Authentication information is subject to the configured session, expiry, and revocation rules. Cached resources support the application interface under degraded connectivity; the Service is not wholly offline.

Retention. We retain information only as reasonably needed for the stated purposes, consent conditions, and approved research protocol, including reproducibility, dataset stewardship, security, audit, dispute resolution, and legal requirements.

Draft sample schedule. The periods below are illustrative examples for editing, not statutory requirements or confirmed JasinaHub practices. Before publication, approve them against the consent terms, research protocol, institutional requirements, and actual deletion and backup capabilities. They do not override earlier erasure obligations.

Record category	Sample retention rule
Account and contact records	Retained for 30 days after account closure to complete account administration.
Consent, withdrawal, and rights requests	Consent records: 5 years after study completion, to document authorised processing. Withdrawal and rights-request records: 3 years after resolution, to document the response and compliance.
Rejected or abandoned recordings	Deleted within 30 days after rejection or after a submission is marked abandoned.
Accepted recordings, transcripts, and metadata	Retained for 5 years after study completion for research validation and reproducibility, with continued necessity reviewed every 12 months.
Activity, presence, audit, and security records	Activity and presence records: 90 days after collection. Audit and security records: 12 months after creation.
Browser recovery copies and drafts	Until handled or removed as described above; clearing site data may destroy unsent work.
Backups	Residual copies deleted or overwritten within 90 days after deletion of the corresponding records from active systems.
Controlled exports and recipient copies	Period authorised in the relevant data-access agreement.
Research outputs and trained models	Documented research/model-governance period, subject to the rights and limitations in Section 5.

After the applicable period, information is securely deleted, de-identified, or retained only for a lawful, documented reason.

Safeguards. Controls include database Row-Level Security, separate role records, administrator verification, approved transcriber access, email/password authentication, restricted export functions, activity logging, and administrative quality review. Atomic transcription-candidate reservations prevent concurrent work; the described deployment uses a configurable 10-minute lease. Exports omit names, while upload recovery reduces accidental loss. Source-code transparency supplements these safeguards; it does not guarantee security or anonymity.

No transmission or storage system is completely secure. We investigate, mitigate, and document breaches, and notify the ODPC and affected people within legally required periods where the relevant notification conditions apply. Report a security concern using Section 6 for escalation to DeKUT's data protection office.

5. Your Rights and Choices

Participation and eligibility. Participation is voluntary and intended for adults aged **18 years or older**. You may skip prompts, stop recording, or leave without submitting work. Do not create a participant account or submit recordings if under 18. If we learn that children's data were collected without appropriate authorisation, we will take reasonable steps to remove them.

Do not record others without authority or disclose names, addresses, identification numbers, telephone numbers, or other private information in contributions. Identifying content may be flagged, marked as [personal information] in a transcript, redacted where practicable, or rejected during review.

Data-protection rights. Subject to applicable law, you may:

- be informed about processing and request access to your personal data;
- request correction, object to processing, or request restriction;
- withdraw consent, delete your account, and request erasure of eligible contributions;
- request portable data where that right applies; and
- request information and human review concerning significant solely automated decisions.

These rights concern your personal data, including recordings, transcripts, account details, and linked activity records, not only contact information. Send a request to dsail-info@dkut.ac.ke, preferably from your account email, identifying the request and relevant records. We may verify your identity. Subject to applicable exceptions, we provide access within seven days and respond to rectification or erasure requests within fourteen days. We explain lawful limitations, refusals, extensions, or permitted fees and offer internal reconsideration.

Withdrawal and completed research. Withdrawal does not invalidate earlier lawful processing. After verification, we remove eligible information from active systems and exclude it from future dataset releases and training runs where required and reasonably practicable. We instruct authorised recipients to restrict or erase eligible copies when required by law or agreement. Necessary compliance records and backup copies pending overwrite may remain.

Completed publications, aggregate results, irreversibly anonymised material, or model parameters from which a contribution cannot reasonably be isolated may limit removal. Each limitation is assessed and explained individually. Trained models are not an automatic exemption from your rights.

Browser controls. You may clear or restrict site storage through browser settings, but this can sign you out, remove unsent audio or drafts, or disable functions. Clearing local data does not delete server-held contributions. This notice does not promise a telemetry-disable setting. The described deployment does not use advertising cookies or third-party behavioural advertising; if non-essential tracking is introduced, we will update this notice and obtain consent where required.

6. Contact, Complaints, and Policy Updates

For privacy, participation, security, support, collaboration, or rights requests, contact:

Controller	Dedan Kimathi University of Technology, acting through DSAIL
Address	Along Nyeri–Mweiga Road; P.O. Box 657–10100, Nyeri, Kenya
Privacy and support	dsail-info@dkut.ac.ke ; requests may be referred to the University’s designated data protection office
Policy page	jasinahub.vercel.app/privacy-policy

You may complain to Kenya’s **Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC)** through [its complaint service](#). Contacts: info@odpc.go.ke; 020 780 1800. The Nyeri regional contact is nyeri@odpc.go.ke.

We may update this policy as practices change, showing its version and revision date on the policy page and providing notice and renewed consent where required. External websites and repository hosts have their own privacy notices. Never post private participant data in public issues or discussions.